



University of Bergen

Candidate number: 106

Words: 2165

Link to portfolio: https://dikult105.k.uib.no/2024H/students/olke9146/final_portfolio/

Table of Content

1.0 Introduction	3
1.1 Context and purpose.....	3
1.2 Personal goals	3
1.3 Wireframes	3
2.0 The portfolio development process	4
2.1 Design Choices	4
2.11 Index.html: The Introduction page.....	4
2.12 Home.html: The Navigation Hub.....	5
2.13 About.html: Introducing Myself.....	5
2.14 Contact.html: Contact Info and Social Links	6
2.15 Skills.html: Assignments and Projects	6
2.16 Jobs.html: Timeline of Jobs	6
2.17 Gallary.html: Dynamic Image Grid.....	7
2.18 Hobbies.html: Hobbies	7
2.2 Content Organization.....	7
2.3 Coding Journey.....	7
2.4 Responsivity and Accesibility.....	8
3.0 Critical reflections	8
3.1 Challenges and Solutions	8
3.2 Strenghts and Weakness	8
4.0 Conclution	9
5.0 Referances	9

1.0 Introduction

1.1 Context and purpose

The Web Design 1 course focuses on various web design principles such as usability, accessibility and responsive design. Through the production of my portfolio, I wanted to reflect around these design principles in a creative way and ensure that it was well adapted to different devices. In this essay, I will explain the process of creating this portfolio, from an idea to a fully coded website. I will describe the challenges I faced, how I solved them, things I have learned and justify all the decisions and choices I have made along the way.

1.2 Personal goals

My goal for this assignment was to create a unique and creative portfolio. A simple layout, with understandable features, and giving a "wow" effect as you browse through it. Inspired by *White Space Is Not Your Enemy*, I have actively used white space to achieve this simplicity, to fill the screen with elements that attract attention, convey information effectively and create a memorable visual experience¹. This has guided me to create an engaging portfolio.

1.3 Wireframes

The first phase in this project was creating wireframes, editable templates that shows the grid and design structure.² This was a useful tool for planning the looks, organization, and structure of the portfolio. In this phase I decided the overall design, what pages to include, and the structure of each of them. My first thought was an idea of a circular navigation menu, looking like a pizza. Further in the process I developed this to look more like a wheel with round buttons along the edges, and a central hole with a picture of me. *Figure 1* shows the wireframe of the introduction page (index.html), and *Figure 2* illustrates the original wireframe of the navigation menu (home.html).

¹ Kim Golombisky and Rebecca Hagen, *White Space Is Not Your Enemy: A Beginner's Guide to Communicating Visually Through Graphic, Web and Multimedia Design*. (Burlington, MA: Focal Press/Elsevier, 2010), 6.

² Golombisky and Hagen, *White Space Is Not Your Enemy*, 227.

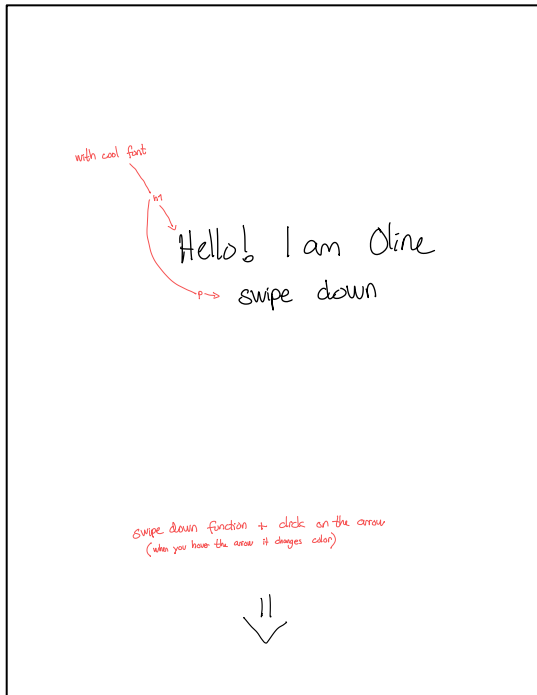


Figure 1: Introduction page



Figure 2: Navigation bar

2.0 The Portfolio Development Process

2.1 Design Choices

Each page is designed to balance usability, responsiveness, and creativity, creating a visually engaging and intuitive user experience. To ensure a similar design, all pages with different sections use a common stylesheet, `categories.css`, with common, light background color, header style, and back button inspired by a design by an existing project called “Chilly Moose - Back Button”, which is distributed under the MIT license³. Modifications have been made to adapt it to my project, like the thickness. In addition to this common stylesheet, the pages have their own individual stylesheets for their unique content.

2.11 Index.html: The Introduction page

The purpose of `index.html` is to provide an informative and engaging introduction to the portfolio. The first thing you see here is a clear heading with the text "Hi, my name is Oline" that catches your attention, followed by a `<p>` element under, giving the instructions to “swipe down” or click on the animated arrow to continue⁴. A JavaScript function will detect

³ Nawsome, "Chilly Moose – Back Button," *Uiverse*, 2024, accessed December 10, 2024, <https://uiverse.io/Nawsome/chilly-moose-65>.

⁴ Nawsome, «Chilly Moose – Back Button,»

swiping, scrolling, or clicking on the arrow, which will then trigger a CSS animation that creates a smooth transition before the user is redirected to the homepage. This leads us to `home.html`, the navigation bar.

2.12 `Home.html`: The Navigation Bar

The homepage meets us with a descriptive header, and a dark gray circular navigation bar centered below. The bar gives a strong contrast to the light background, surrounded by round, colorful buttons, and has a hole in the middle. The buttons lead to the different sections in the portfolio; “*About-Me*”, “*Contact*”, “*Skills*”, “*Jobs*”, “*Gallery*”, and “*Hobbies*”. This unique choice of navigation bar already makes the page more memorable. The buttons are interactive, featuring hover effects that slightly gets darker followed by a bounce animation. These effects clearly show that the buttons are clickable, making the interface more user-friendly. Hover effects guide focus and highlight interactivity, creating an intuitive and engaging navigation experience⁵.

A rounded profile image is placed in the middle of the navigation bar, precisely positioned using CSS with `position: absolute` on the hole on the navigation bar, `.circle-nav::before`. This technique worked to ensure the image remained perfectly centered regardless of screen. As noted by Robbins, absolute positioning provides a flexible and precise placing of elements on a page⁶. A zoom animation was added, when a navigation wheel is clicked, activated via JavaScript. This “walk-through-effect” drags us in through the navigation wheel, while the heading and profile picture fades out. This transition provides an engaging flow, and a good user experience. I also implemented a search function, that searches for all visible text across the HTML pages, making content easier to find, and strengthening accessibility.

2.13 `About.html`: Introducing Myself

The About page briefly introduces who I am, combining a short text, along with an image built from semantic elements such as `<section>`, `<article>` and `<figure>`. The content is placed inside a grid container, which provides a clear structure by separating text and images and adapts the layout responsively to different screen sizes. The black text gives a strong contrast

⁵ Jennifer Niederst Robbins, *Learning Web Design: A Beginner's Guide to HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Web Graphics*, 5th ed. (Sebastopol, CA: O'Reilly Media, 2018), 318.

⁶ Robbins, *Learning Web Design*, 408.

against the light background, and the image is slightly rounded. A gray "Contact Me" button is placed below, with a hover effect, which leads to the contact page.

2.14 Contact.html: Contact Info and Social Links

The contact page is an important part of the portfolio, because it allows others to contact me. Inside a grid with a 2px black border, with a clean design, is address info, phone number and email address organized, with a matching icon on the left side, instead of text. These icons have "alt" with text description, which increases the accessibility. Further, there are clickable icons for social platforms, such as LinkedIn, GitHub, Facebook and Instagram. GitHub is especially valuable for employers, as it provides access to my earlies projects.

2.15 Skills.html: Assignments and Projects

The skills page is designed as a digital archive with folder icons representing various projects, including assignments as CA1 and CA2, including WA1 and WA2, which is styled as Word-documents. I have also included the student interview we did first week, which I have chosen to display as a chat log, with scrolling function and gradient background. Additional information is displayed by hover effect, which creates an interactive interface. Flexbox is used to ensure a responsive layout of the folder icons, which adapts to all screen sizes⁷. All other projects here have been done earlier and have not been used in other exams or submissions.

2.16 Jobs.html: Timeline of Jobs

The Jobs page is designed to display work experience through a vertical timeline, which works better on different screen sizes than a horizontal one. The most recent work experiences are displayed at the top, with older further down. Each job includes a short description, placed in a simple layout of white boxes. The orange dots on the line match the orange color that was the color of the jobs.html button, and the timeline is inspired from w3 school⁸.

⁷ Robbins, *Learning Web Design*, 419.

⁸ W3Schools, "How to Create a Timeline," *W3Schools*, accessed December 7, 2024, https://www.w3schools.com/howto/howto_css_timeline.asp.

2.17 Gallery.html: Dynamic Image Grid

The gallery page is a responsive grid with images in four distinct sizes, each defined by a specific class name: "gallery-element" for standard images, "gallery-element-large" for images spanning two columns and two rows, "gallery-element-wide" for images spanning two columns and one row, and "gallery-element-tall" for images spanning one column and two rows. Hovering over an image will display a short description.

Balanced spacing between images and rounded corners creates a nice aesthetic, maintained regardless of device size. The layout adapts well to different screen sizes, but I change sizes and layouts based on what looks best on the different devices. I used `<div>` elements to build this gallery, because `<figure>` or `<section>` did not achieve wanted result. The design is inspired by W3Schools guide to responsive image grids ⁹.

2.18 Hobbies.html: Hobbies

The hobby page shows three of my hobbies, each with a title, and a short description with an image below. The hobby titles are designed with a purple color, similar to the navigation button to hobbies. The page starts with an introduction, followed by three purple buttons that provide direct navigation to each hobby section further down. Alternatively, you can scroll manually, but in the bottom right corner there is a scroll up button that takes you back to the top of the page.

2.2 Content Organization

For organization, I have used grid and flexbox to create flexible and responsive layouts, as well as `<section>` and `<article>` to group related sections. The navigation wheel in home.html is built with `<section>` as the main container, and subcomponents organized with `<nav>`, which improves semantic clarity¹⁰. I chose to keep all the JavaScript code in scripts inside the HTML files, as the focus here was design and use of HTML and CSS.

⁹ W3Schools, "How to Create a Responsive Image Grid," *W3Schools*, accessed December 7, 2024, https://www.w3schools.com/howto/howto_css_image_grid_responsive.asp.

¹⁰ Robbins, *Learning Web Design*, p. 87.

2.3 Coding Journey

Throughout the development of my portfolio, I made a journal to document my thoughts, identify areas for improvement, and track ideas as they emerged. I also had others test my portfolio, which provided valuable feedback and confirmed both the strengths of my portfolio and areas that could be improved. For example, I had a more complex idea for my gallery page but was confirmed through feedback that it looked great, which convinced me to just keep it as it was. This allowed me to save time and focus on other tasks instead.

2.4 Responsibility and Accessibility

“Alt” attributes are consistently implemented in the code to improve accessibility, especially for users who use screen readers. This helps to make the page more accessible, for those who, for example, must use a screen reader. For example, this is implemented in the gallery section, where each image has a short description in the alt text. This gives users who cannot see the images an opportunity to gain insight into what is displayed on the page, and makes it more accessible ¹¹. Breakpoints with media queries is widely used to adapt the portfolio to all devices, but the structure and organization in the code could have been improved.

3.0 Reflections

Through this experience I have learned a lot about accessibility, universal design and availability. I have experienced that it is very time-consuming to get ideas through and adapt them well to all the design principles. Things take time when it comes to design, and there are always things to improve.

3.1 Challenges and Solutions

Sometimes on different devices, there were small changes that needed to be adjusted, in terms of text size, navigation buttons, and circle thickness. To debug different devices in my breakpoints, I temporarily added a blue color to the navigation text on the button, which helped me to figure out where I was in my code.

The distance between the top of the screen and the content was too large on mobile devices, which was discovered when I opened the project on my phone. This issue did not show up in

¹¹ Laura Kalbag, *Accessibility for Everyone* (New York: A Book Apart, 2017), p. 79

Google Chromes device simulator, that showed the project in different devices. I solved this by increasing the margin-top, as it was important for me to ensure that the navigation bar was centered on the screen for this device, for an easy access to the buttons.

3.2 Strengths and Weakness

The strength of my portfolio is its unique design, which stands out and is not like other portfolios. As a weakness, I could have implemented functionality such as language selection, which would have made the site more accessible or a dark mode and light mode button, which would have increased accessibility.

Users needed to click through several pages to fully review the portfolio, is also considered as a weakness. However, this is to ensure a clear structure and improve navigation for the users, which increases accessibility. Even though you must click a few times, this structure and organization strengthens the design principle of accessibility. Since the portfolio is clear in the organization of content, I would also argue that this strengthens the design principle of usability, because the design is effective, and users know where to click to get where they want. I base this on feedback from others and my own opinion.

4.0 Conclusion

My goal was to balance creativity with simplicity, which I believe I did. Feedback was crucial to improving the quality and ensuring functionality. The portfolio allowed me to explore important web design principles such as accessibility, usability, and responsive design. Coming up with both creative and unique was absolutely the most challenging part of the project. Making wireframes and coding journey including my thoughts and ideas during the process, made me come up with different ideas, and choose the ones that were best according to the design principles, like accessibility, semantic markup and flexibility.

Even though I faced challenges, I resolved them to the best of my ability. Advanced ideas are not always the best, sometimes simple ones work out just as well. Starting early was crucial factor for achieving the desired result, as design is an iterative process where there is always room for improvement. The portfolio includes all the required elements specified in the assignment, along with additional features that enhance its quality and make it uniquely suited to my style and approach.

5.0 References

Golombisky, Kim, and Rebecca Hagen. *White Space Is Not Your Enemy: A Beginner's Guide to Communicating Visually Through Graphic, Web and Multimedia Design*. Burlington, MA: Focal Press, 2010.

Kalbag, Laura. *Accessibility for Everyone*. New York: A Book Apart, 2017.

Nawsome. "Chilly Moose - Back Button." *Uiverse*. Accessed December 12, 2024. <https://uiverse.io/Nawsome/chilly-moose-65>.

Robbins, Jennifer Niederst. *Learning Web Design: A Beginner's Guide to HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Web Graphics*. 5th ed. Sebastopol, CA: O'Reilly Media, 2018.

W3Schools. "How to Create a Responsive Image Grid." *W3Schools*. Accessed December 7, 2024. https://www.w3schools.com/howto/howto_css_image_grid_responsive.asp.

W3Schools. "How to Create a Timeline." *W3Schools*. Accessed December 7, 2024. https://www.w3schools.com/howto/howto_css_timeline.asp.